

Secure your home network

Download and Install Nessus Essentials for Education free

** Only scan networks you own or have written permission to test!!

Nessus Essentials runs natively on Windows 11 (both x64 and ARM64 are supported in current releases).

For cybersecurity it's one of the easiest ways to introduce professional vulnerability scanning without requiring Linux or a VM. Further it is still a DoD baseline tool

What you'll need

Windows 11 (64-bit)

Administrator privileges

Internet connection (for activation and plugin downloads)

Approximately 2–4 GB of free disk space (more is better as the plugin database grows)

Limitations of Nessus Essentials

- Free for personal, educational, and other non-commercial use
- Limited to 16 IP addresses per scanner
 - Will not perform a Discover scan of your 192.168 network, but we will use nmap for that and then type in the IP addresses of the online systems from that. We will save the scan for later use.
- No commercial use
- Some advanced reporting and enterprise features are not included.

Installation Steps

- Go to the official Tenable Nessus Essentials page.
- Register with your ENMU.edu email to receive a free activation code.
- Download the Windows x64 installer.
- Run the .msi installer as Administrator.

After installation completes, your browser will open to:

<https://localhost:8834>

- Select Nessus Essentials.

- Enter the activation code sent by email.
- Wait for Nessus to download its plugins (this can take 10–30 minutes depending on your connection).
- Create/use an administrator account for the scanner.